

Tuners

Walked across the way to the bodega. For some Arrogant Bastard beer, they walked, and walked, and walked. For all of 5 minutes. It was down the corner and on another one. They walked, down their block and leapfrogged through an intersection to the uh, the opposing corner. “Walkin’ the Double Hypotenuse” they called it. They didn’t know much math, but they knew enough. To make such jokes, they did. A cackle, a jingle. They sang. The Bottom Dog pullt oot his Harmon & Kardon speaker and began, for the 2xHypoCross, to play some Mingus or Scotty La. Double Hypo? Some double bass *required* reading. They called it—the listening of double bass during a Walkin’ Double Hypotenuse—the Quadrangle Jangle Wrangle. I mention I’m a tuner, too? You ain’t gettin’ none of our secrets, boy. Best be takin’ these nuggets of in-grouperedness with a grain of glass that’s got a smaller grain uh salt in it. Anyhow, our group delicacy is grouper. And we also enjoy calling 2xBass on the 2xHypoCross a little bit of *required* reading and so therefore, we call it reading the paper. Like all our pappies did when we were young & Quadrangle Jangle Wrangling for the first or second time or. Get the idea or scram! Naw, naw: I’m just messin. I have more to say. Impartic’lar that, among tuners at least, a 2xHypoCross is considered near-holy. When explenned to the layfolk, they usually characterize it as dangerous and greedy. To which we, the ooners, agreedy. But, impertently, we think of it as such—greedy and dangerous—yet also as being a joyous thing. Without taking joy in the harmlessly dangerous and greedy, you can sort of stop to live. It’s our way of saying, Yes: danger, Yes: greed, Yes: *play*. We linger in that 2xHypoCross, because the opera-unity (“opportunity”) isn’t common, is savored, isn’t sad. Always appreciated... Hm. I’m missing something. Leaving at that it feels wrong.

I’ve heard talk from a certain somebody in our interviewings that there’s something by the name of “komorebi.” *PHI-lo-so-phy* student she said she was. Well but she said this komorebi word and that was about it. A smoking gun, a golden ticket. I brought the word, on a piece of scrap paper, to the head tuner to review and recollect (Platonist he was at the time). We looked it up and sure enough: we’re light. The light, I should say. You don’t get it? Did you look up the word, yet? ... How about now? ... Tip tap, pitter patter, go get your dictionadder. Snip snap click clack hiss pwap. Done? Okay, here goes: we’re the light! Well no not always and forever like marriage. No. I mean, during 2xHypoCrosses, we’re the light. Because, see, komorebi refers to that light that passes through the leaves of trees and casts shadows around and through those same leaves. So I guess maybe we’re the assemblage of said painting. No wait no yeah, we’re the light! We pass through the intersection and you absolutely can *not* convince me that the smiles I see when we QuadJangWrang are *not* real. Just can’t. Jamboree of a presence we are. We’re like komorebi and now you know how. You also tricked me into explaining, in my very own words, how and what komorebi is *to* me. You must have been a teacher at some point, gettin’ me to show my work like that.

One of them, the head tuner, offered a drink of choice as is oft the Case—for as you all *must* know, tuners drank in the same key—and they usually always assented to this head tuner’s choice. Because it was always the same lately anyway: Arrogant Bastard. But don’t get it all confused or spangled, they drank of different capaciousnesses. A small tuner, why, he’d get a large bottle and the largest tuner the smallest thimble of Arrogance. They’d recently started up and booted up and turned over a new scheme. Namely, to grow chest hair for the less fortunate. Arrogant Bastard was, to their mind, the best manner of keeping turnover high. Chest hair turnover, if that wasn’t clear. The *group* turnover practically nil. No applicants being watched for, neither, so don’t get any ideas. Of subtractive or additive varieties. This posse knows math jokes, remember? But so anyhow, yes, the Arrogant Bastard and the chest hair scheme. They were tuners and they crossreferenced their calipers amongst themselves, from shave to shave. A few kept beards, a few didn’t. The debate was wholesome and lively on no- vs yes-beard. A couple-three tunes (not to be confused with “songs”) adamantly thought that eyeglasses were crucial to safe shaving (of chest or other) and so either discarded their contact lenses (none did because they were tuners and didn’t like shit in their eyes in the first place) or kept wearing their glasses (no change from the others’ perspective) or, in one case, “store” (past tense of “stare” (don’t ask)) into, yes, the one and only sun for a chance at glasses. To concreify and solididate (again, terms were made but not by me) his commitment to Tunel Motion (like “tunnel” but with a tune).

Hadn’t thought of it, but I wonder how it is that that partic’lar tuner lost ANY sight if he’s light, himself. Weird. ANYWAY, as I was SAYING, d’you know what it means to be DubbleHypoCrosser? That’s what it was, the cross! We’re tuners for fun, y’see. We all for the Red Cross, for work, y’hear. Well, as volunteers. But we still do it and we don’t care much for the cost to our times. The tuning? That’s more to pay the pills than anything else. What do we tune? Anything that can be. Pianos, cars, instruments: violins, pianos, guitars, electric guitars, electric basses, basses, faces, even chakras but some folks take issue and start pickin bones on that count so we don’t usually advertise it, back of house type of service that one, our logic bein’ that any personage who believes in us makes us worth believin’ in. Kina like when a new piece of music is born and, so long as ONE person or thing or noun or whatever likes it, it’s GOOD. G-O-O-D. An elongated God we call that. Some call it a stalled God or laggy God, which is fine and fair and not foul to THEM, but t’us? Quite foul indeed. B’so yes, my point here is that we are attuned to all tunings, bigger market, y’see? No I hear it too, yeah, very funny.

“Do we mourn?” Well yes of course we do. I’ll give you a guess if you like. Advent of certain technologies caused some mourning for our lil business, to be quite honest and frank with you. People stopped tuning in their TVs and radios to certain channels and frequencies at a certain point and we of course felt this. For see, during the “droughts”—or shucks, well—should I tell em?—we call them tunings, and we apologize to the governing bodies for this positive characterization of the uh, what do you call em again? O, yeah. “Droughts,”

or whatever the fu—anyhow, the... What was my train of thought going towards?—...O, right. The tunings are a bit of an orgy for us. What do you mean the interview's over?